

THE PLAYER-COACH PLAYBOOK

Lesson 1

Suit Up: Your Leadership M.V.P.

About 50 minutes of reps this week. Your core rep, Drill 1.4, is the Starting Line: 30 minutes with your Athleader.

M.V.P. Accelerator™

POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™

LESSON 1 · GOES WITH VIDEO 1.1

Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 1

Welcome to your first week, Player-Coach. This week is about laying the foundation for a successful season by establishing your role, your own intention, and a clear, committed partnership with your Athleader.

"The foundation of every great team is a clear, committed partnership between the player and the Player-Coach."

This week's A.R.A.W. focus:

Alignment Wellbeing

Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- Understand your role as a Player-Coach in the Athleadership model.
- Define your own "Player-Coach Intention" with a focus on your wellbeing and leadership growth.
- Identify a key "Player-Coach Multiplier" opportunity with your Athleader.
- Facilitate a structured Starting Line to create a foundation of trust and clarity.

Ground Your Intention

Review the two questions you reflected on at the start of this lesson. Keep them front and center as you complete these drills to ensure your work is targeted and meaningful.

What is one leadership behavior you want to strengthen for yourself?

What is one leadership behavior you want to improve in how you support your team's performance?

START HERE

Drill 1.4: Your Starting Line

Your core rep this week, about 30 minutes.

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LESSON 1 · ABOUT 50 MINUTES OF REPS THIS WEEK

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills

Lead self first, then lead others. Your core rep is the Starting Line with your Athleader.

Drill 1.2

EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME

Define Your Player-Coach Intention

Alignment · lead self

10 min

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Drill 1.3

EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME

Identify the Multiplier Effect

Alignment · lead others

10 min

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Drill 1.4

CORE REP · START HERE

The First Conversation: Your Starting Line

Alignment · lead others

30 min

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Fill it in on screen. Type straight into the grey boxes and tick the boxes that apply. Save the file to keep your answers.

Or on paper. Print the pages and write by hand.

Then get feedback. Run your core rep, then ask your Athleader how it landed.

Drill 1.2 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 10 minutes · Goes with Video 1.2

LEAD SELF: Define Your Player-Coach Intention

Great coaching starts with self-awareness. Before you can guide your Athleader, you need to know what you want out of this experience for your own growth. This is your first step in leading yourself (Alignment and Wellbeing), so you can more effectively lead others.

Step 1

Identify Your Pressure Point

What is one specific pressure point (e.g., tight deadlines, team conflict, managing up) you are currently facing in your role? *This helps you focus on a real-world challenge where you can apply what you are learning immediately.*

Step 2

Define Your Wellbeing Practice

What is one wellbeing practice (e.g., taking a 15-minute walk at lunch, ending the workday at a set time, delegating one task) you can implement this week to manage that pressure and perform sustainably? *This is your first A.R.A.W. check-in, connecting wellbeing directly to performance.*

3 State Your Intention

Combine your reflections into a single, powerful intention statement. This intention will be your anchor for this season, and you will share it with your Athleader at your Starting Line.

My intention for this M.V.P. Accelerator season is to

Drill 1.3 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 10 minutes · Goes with Video 1.3

LEAD OTHERS: Identify the Multiplier Effect

Your leadership is a catalyst. This drill helps you strategically focus your coaching on the area where your Athleader's growth will have the biggest ripple effect on the team and business, maximizing the "Player-Coach Multiplier Effect."

Step 1

Identify a Growth Area

What is one area of growth for your Athleader (e.g., technical skill, presentation skills, cross-functional collaboration) that, if improved, would have the largest positive impact on the rest of the team?

Step 2

Connect to a Business Goal

How does this growth area connect to one of your team's key business goals for this quarter? *This creates clear alignment between individual development and business outcomes.*

Step 3

Align with Stakeholders

Have you translated direction from your senior leaders into clear, actionable steps for your team related to this? How could you align stakeholders outside of your immediate team to support this goal? *This drill links to the assessment theme of organizational alignment and ensuring your team understands the "why" behind their work.*

Drill 1.4 | Core rep · start here | About 30 minutes · Goes with Video 1.4

LEAD OTHERS: The First Conversation, Your Starting Line

This meeting is the single most important play call of this lesson. It moves your relationship from one of unspoken assumptions to one of explicit, aligned partnership.

Bring Melissa's Commitment and Starting Line agenda (in the Resources list). It follows the five parts below. The lines from this Playbook help you prepare what you'll say.

With: _____ Date: _____ Time: _____

Step 1

Arrive (5 min)

What are you walking into this experience carrying right now? One word is enough. Share more if you want to.

Your opening

"Thanks for meeting. I'm excited to go on this journey with you as a partnership. While you're going through the Athleader track, I'm going through this Player-Coach track to become a better Player-Coach for you and the team."

My word: _____

Step 2

Name the Win (10 min)

Athleader: 90 days from now, what do you want to be different in how you lead? Player-Coach: if that change is happening, what might you notice? Then switch. Player-Coach: what do you want to strengthen in how you lead over these 90 days? Athleader: if that change is happening, what might I experience differently?

Sharing intentions

"Thank you for sharing. My intention as your Player-Coach is [share your intention from Drill 1.2]. I'm sharing this because I want us to hold each other accountable and be partners in this growth." Listen intently. Ask clarifying questions like, "What makes that so important to you right now?" or "What would achieving that unlock for you?"

What I want to strengthen in how I lead over these 90 days:

Step 3

Get Honest (5 min)

When things get busy, what are you each most likely to stop doing first? No judgment. Know your pattern. What will help you come back?

My pattern, and what helps me come back:

Step 4

Name What You Need (5 min)

What do you need from each other for this experience to matter? And one agreement: can we give each other honest perspective, even when it may be easier not to?

Support and psychological safety

Ask for needs: "What is the most important thing you need from me to feel supported and safe to take risks on this journey?" This question directly addresses the core competency of creating psychological safety, a key theme in your assessment. State your needs: "To be the best Player-Coach I can be for you, what I need is [e.g., for you to be proactive in sharing your insights, for you to be open when you face a challenge]. This will help us build a strong foundation of trust."

What I need from my Athleader:

Step 5

Set the Rhythm (5 min)

When will we check in? Put your next conversation on the calendar now. Then decide: if we lose the rhythm, how will we call each other back in? That's your reset.

Set the rhythm

"Let's set up a recurring 15-minute check-in specifically for this experience. This will be our dedicated time to connect on your progress. Let's get it on the calendar now."

Our check-in, day: _____ Time: _____

Our reset: _____

☐ We signed Our Commitment together, at the end of the Starting Line.

"I am a manager who manages several participants."

Great. This journey supports your growth and your team's. If you manage multiple participants, hold one 30-minute Starting Line with each person at the start. After that, build the 15-minute check-ins into your existing meeting rhythm. No need to create additional meetings.



"Great leaders don't wait for change; they create it."

Locker Room Reflection

Challenge: During your Starting Line, your Athleader seems hesitant and gives very general answers about their goals. How do you apply the principle of psychological safety to encourage openness without applying pressure? What specific question could you ask to build trust?

This reflection goes with the real-world challenge from Video 1.4.

My notes

Get feedback

Run your core rep, then ask your Athleader how it landed.

Who I asked: _____

What they said, and what I'll keep doing:

Back in the course: your Athleader Pro Huddle with Tracey Newell, then your Pulse Check.